

Hispanic Heritage · 30 People

Student activity packet · Grades 9–12 · English learners

Ten activities built on the thirty bilingual profiles, from recognizing names to producing writing and speech, with a lane for every proficiency level.

What's inside

#	Activity	What it is
1	Who am I?	Match clues to names. Recognition, whole class, 15 min.
2	Sort the thirty	Five fields, thirty names. Categorizing, pairs, 15 min.
3	Close reading	Three bilingual profiles with questions. Reading, individual, 30 min.
4	Words that matter	Academic verbs from the profiles. Vocabulary, pairs, 20 min.
5	Profile card	One person, one card, one illustration. Writing, individual, 30 min.
6	Two lives, one connection	Compare two people across fields. Writing, pairs, 25 min.
7	Let's talk cards	All thirty discussion questions to cut out. Speaking, groups, 20 min.
8	Research feature	Plan and write a 100-word profile with sources. Research, individual, one period.
9	Gallery walk	Respond to three classmates' profiles. Reading and writing, whole class, 20 min.
10	Heritage bingo	Two boards and a call list. Listening, whole class, 15 min.

Four lanes, every activity

Newcomer	Uses the Spanish profile first, then the English. Answers by matching, circling, pointing or copying. Speech is optional; a drawing counts as a response.
Emerging	Uses the sentence frames as printed. Two or three complete sentences is a full success. Spanish notes in the margin are welcome.
Progressing	Frames optional. Answers in paragraphs with a reason and a detail from the text. Must use the academic verbs from Activity 4.
Challenge	Adds a source check, a counter-example or a comparison to a person not in the packet. Presents orally to the class.
Say out loud	The gallery portraits are AI-generated interpretations, not photographs. Say so when students see them, and send them to the source link on each profile. Activity 8 is where they practice doing that.

ACTIVIDAD 1 • ACTIVITY 1

Who am I? • ¿Quién soy?

Read each clue. Write the name from the word bank.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Word bank • Banco de palabras
César Chávez · Ellen Ochoa · Frida Kahlo · Jaime Escalante · Julia Alvarez · Lin-Manuel Miranda ·
Oscar De La Hoya · Roberto Clemente · Severo Ochoa · Sonia Sotomayor

1.	This person is an American engineer of Mexican heritage. <i>Esta persona es una ingeniera estadounidense de ascendencia mexicana.</i>	_____ _____
2.	This person was a Mexican American labor leader. <i>Esta persona fue un líder sindical mexicoamericano.</i>	_____ _____
3.	This person grew up in New York City in a Puerto Rican family. <i>Esta persona creció en la ciudad de Nueva York en una familia puertorriqueña.</i>	_____ _____
4.	This person was a Puerto Rican baseball star who played for the Pittsburgh Pirates. <i>Esta persona fue una estrella puertorriqueña del béisbol que jugó para los Piratas de Pittsburgh.</i>	_____ _____
5.	This person was a Mexican painter known for her self-portraits. <i>Esta persona fue una pintora mexicana conocida por sus autorretratos.</i>	_____ _____
6.	This person is an American composer and performer of Puerto Rican heritage. <i>Esta persona es un compositor y artista estadounidense de ascendencia puertorriqueña.</i>	_____ _____
7.	This person is a Dominican American writer. <i>Esta persona es una escritora dominicoamericana.</i>	_____ _____
8.	This person was a Bolivian American mathematics teacher. <i>Esta persona fue un profesor de matemáticas bolivianoestadounidense.</i>	_____ _____
9.	This person is a Mexican American boxer from East Los Angeles. <i>Esta persona es un boxeador mexicoamericano de East Los Angeles.</i>	_____ _____
10.	This person was a Spanish American biochemist. <i>Esta persona fue un bioquímico hispanoestadounidense.</i>	_____ _____

Newcomer: use the Spanish line. **Challenge:** write one more clue for a person not in the word bank and give it to a partner.

ACTIVIDAD 2 · ACTIVITY 2

Sort the thirty · Clasifica a las treinta personas

Write each number under the field where the person belongs. Use the gallery.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

#	Name	Roles	#	Name	Roles
01	Ellen Ochoa	Engineer, Astronaut, Leader	16	Rita Moreno	Actor, Singer, Dancer
02	José Hernández	Engineer, Astronaut	17	Lin-Manuel Miranda	Composer, Writer, Performer
03	Franklin Chang-Díaz	Physicist, Astronaut	18	Gabriela Mistral	Poet, Educator
04	Mario Molina	Chemist, Environmental Scientist	19	Isabel Allende	Novelist, Storyteller
05	Luis Walter Alvarez	Physicist, Inventor	20	Julia Alvarez	Author, Poet, Educator
06	César Chávez	Labor Leader, Civil Rights Advocate	21	Antonia Novello	Physician, Public Health Leader
07	Dolores Huerta	Labor Leader, Community Organizer	22	Jaime Escalante	Mathematics Teacher, Educator
08	Sonia Sotomayor	Judge, Author	23	Sandra Cisneros	Author, Poet
09	Sylvia Mendez	Civil Rights Advocate	24	Carlos Santana	Guitarist, Songwriter
10	Roberto Clemente	Baseball Player, Humanitarian	25	Oscar De La Hoya	Boxer, Olympic Champion
11	Frida Kahlo	Painter, Artist	26	Pura Belpré	Librarian, Author, Storyteller
12	Diego Rivera	Painter, Mural Artist	27	Tito Puente	Musician, Composer, Bandleader
13	Celia Cruz	Singer, Performer	28	Laurie Hernandez	Gymnast, Olympic Champion
14	Selena Quintanilla	Singer, Performer	29	Severo Ochoa	Biochemist, Researcher
15	Gloria Estefan	Singer, Songwriter	30	Evelyn Miralles	Engineer, Technology Innovator

Science, Space & Health	Justice & Community	Arts & Music	Words & Learning	Sports
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Then: which field has the most people? Which has the fewest? Why do you think that is? Answer in two sentences.

ACTIVIDAD 3 · ACTIVITY 3

Close reading · Lectura atenta

Read each profile twice. Answer in complete sentences.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Ellen Ochoa · Engineer, Astronaut, Leader

Ellen Ochoa is an American engineer of Mexican heritage. In 1993, she became the first Hispanic woman to travel to space. She flew on four space missions and later led NASA's Johnson Space Center.

Ellen Ochoa es una ingeniera estadounidense de ascendencia mexicana. En 1993, se convirtió en la primera mujer hispana en viajar al espacio. Participó en cuatro misiones espaciales y después dirigió el Centro Espacial Johnson de la NASA.

1. What is the first thing the text says about this person?

2. Find one word you did not know. Write it and what you think it means.

3. Why does this person matter? Use one detail from the text.

4. What preparation might a space mission require?

Frame: *Ellen Ochoa contributed by _____. This matters because _____.*

Dolores Huerta · Labor Leader, Community Organizer

Dolores Huerta is a Mexican American labor leader. She helped organize the union that became the United Farm Workers. Through negotiations and community action, she worked to improve farmworkers' wages, working conditions, and rights.

Dolores Huerta es una líder sindical mexicoamericana. Ayudó a organizar el sindicato que llegó a ser United Farm Workers. Mediante negociaciones y acciones comunitarias, trabajó para mejorar los salarios, las condiciones laborales y los derechos de los trabajadores agrícolas.

1. What is the first thing the text says about this person?

2. Find one word you did not know. Write it and what you think it means.

3. Why does this person matter? Use one detail from the text.

4. How does organizing help workers speak together?

Frame: Dolores Huerta contributed by _____. This matters because _____.

Lin-Manuel Miranda · Composer, Writer, Performer

Lin-Manuel Miranda is an American composer and performer of Puerto Rican heritage. He created the musicals *In the Heights* and *Hamilton*. His work combines storytelling with musical styles such as hip-hop and Latin music.

Lin-Manuel Miranda es un compositor y artista estadounidense de ascendencia puertorriqueña. Creó los musicales In the Heights y Hamilton. Su obra combina la narración de historias con estilos musicales como el hip-hop y la música latina.

1. What is the first thing the text says about this person?

2. Find one word you did not know. Write it and what you think it means.

3. Why does this person matter? Use one detail from the text.

4. How could music make a historical story memorable?

Frame: *Lin-Manuel Miranda contributed by _____. This matters because _____.*

ACTIVIDAD 4 · ACTIVITY 4

Words that matter · Palabras que importan

The verbs that describe what these people did.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

English	Español	In a sentence
became the first	<i>se convirtió en la primera / el primero</i>	Ellen Ochoa became the first Hispanic woman in space.
led	<i>dirigió</i>	She later led NASA's Johnson Space Center.
founded	<i>fundó</i>	He founded a company to sell his product.
defended	<i>defendió</i>	She defended workers' rights.
created	<i>creó</i>	He created a musical about history.
won	<i>ganó</i>	She won the top prize in her field.
wrote	<i>escribió</i>	He wrote books that are still read today.
discovered	<i>descubrió</i>	He discovered how chemicals damage the ozone layer.

A. Match. Draw a line from each Spanish verb to its English partner. Then cover the table and try again from memory.

<i>se convirtió en la primera / el primero</i>		led
<i>dirigió</i>		founded
<i>fundó</i>		created
<i>defendió</i>		won
<i>creó</i>		became the first
<i>ganó</i>		defended
<i>escribió</i>		discovered
<i>descubrió</i>		wrote

B. Use them. Choose four verbs. Write one sentence about a person from the gallery with each verb. Underline the verb.

Progressing and Challenge: every sentence needs a reason — add *because* or *so that*. **Newcomer:** copy the example sentence and change the name.

ACTIVIDAD 5 · ACTIVITY 5

Profile card · Tarjeta de perfil

Choose one person. Fill the card. Draw or describe.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

NAME · NOMBRE	FIELD · CAMPO
HERITAGE · HERENCIA	NUMBER IN THE GALLERY · NÚMERO

TWO FACTS · DOS DATOS

WHY IT MATTERS · POR QUÉ IMPORTA

PORTRAIT OR SYMBOL · RETRATO O SÍMBOLO

draw here

Frames · Marcos

_____ was a _____ from _____.

She / He is known for _____.

This matters because _____.

One question I would ask is _____.

Question I would ask this person · Una pregunta que le haría:

ACTIVIDAD 6 · ACTIVITY 6

Two lives, one connection · Dos vidas, una conexión

Choose two people from different fields. Find what they share.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

PERSON 1 · PERSONA 1	BOTH · LAS DOS	PERSON 2 · PERSONA 2

Ideas that connect people · Ideas que conectan: access · identity · service · courage · firsts · language · community · education · risk

Frames · Marcos

Both _____ and _____ contributed by _____.

Their work differs because _____.

One idea they share is _____, because _____.

Write your paragraph · Escribe tu párrafo (5–7 sentences)

ACTIVIDAD 7 · ACTIVITY 7

Let's talk cards · Tarjetas para conversar

Cut out. One card per group. Answer, then point to the line in the profile that supports you.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

01 · Ellen Ochoa What preparation might a space mission require? <i>Ellen Ochoa contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	02 · José Hernández How can education expand a person's opportunities? <i>José Hernández contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
03 · Franklin Chang-Díaz Why would engineers study better ways to move rockets? <i>Franklin Chang-Díaz contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	04 · Mario Molina How can a discovery help protect a community? <i>Mario Molina contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
05 · Luis Walter Alvarez Why do scientists need new tools? <i>Luis Walter Alvarez contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	06 · César Chávez How can a boycott support a demand for change? <i>César Chávez contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
07 · Dolores Huerta How does organizing help workers speak together? <i>Dolores Huerta contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	08 · Sonia Sotomayor Why does representation in public service matter? <i>Sonia Sotomayor contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
09 · Sylvia Mendez How can one family help change access to education? <i>Sylvia Mendez contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	10 · Roberto Clemente What makes an athlete a community leader? <i>Roberto Clemente contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
11 · Frida Kahlo What symbols would tell a story about your identity? <i>Frida Kahlo contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	12 · Diego Rivera Where could public art tell your community's story? <i>Diego Rivera contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
13 · Celia Cruz How can music carry culture across borders? <i>Celia Cruz contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	14 · Selena Quintanilla What helps a musical tradition reach new listeners? <i>Selena Quintanilla contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>

15 · Gloria Estefan How can a song connect people who speak different languages? <i>Gloria Estefan contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	16 · Rita Moreno What skills might transfer between theater and film? <i>Rita Moreno contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
17 · Lin-Manuel Miranda How could music make a historical story memorable? <i>Lin-Manuel Miranda contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	18 · Gabriela Mistral How can poetry help people describe difficult feelings? <i>Gabriela Mistral contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
19 · Isabel Allende How can a family story help explain history? <i>Isabel Allende contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	20 · Julia Alvarez How can a novel introduce readers to another community? <i>Julia Alvarez contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
21 · Antonia Novello Why might public health work focus on children? <i>Antonia Novello contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	22 · Jaime Escalante What classroom conditions help students tackle difficult work? <i>Jaime Escalante contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
23 · Sandra Cisneros How can a neighborhood become the setting for a story? <i>Sandra Cisneros contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	24 · Carlos Santana What can musicians create by combining traditions? <i>Carlos Santana contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
25 · Oscar De La Hoya What preparation might an Olympic athlete need? <i>Oscar De La Hoya contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	26 · Pura Belpré How can a library welcome families who speak different languages? <i>Pura Belpré contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
27 · Tito Puente How can rhythm help people connect with a culture? <i>Tito Puente contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	28 · Laurie Hernandez What does a team need from each athlete? <i>Laurie Hernandez contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>
29 · Severo Ochoa How can research on cells help us understand living things? <i>Severo Ochoa contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>	30 · Evelyn Miralles Why might simulated practice help astronauts prepare? <i>Evelyn Miralles contributed by _____. This matters because _____.</i>

ACTIVIDAD 8 · ACTIVITY 8

Research feature · Tu reportaje

One person. One question. Two sources. One hundred words.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Step 1 — Your question · Tu pregunta. Something the profile does not answer.

Step 2 — Two sources · Dos fuentes. The gallery link counts as one.

	Author or organization	Page title	Link	Date you read it
1				
2				

Step 3 — Three facts you verified · Tres datos que verificaste. Write the source number next to each.

Step 4 — Write the profile · Escribe el perfil. About 100 words: who, what they did, why it matters, and one question for readers.

	3	2	1
Accuracy	Every fact traceable to a listed source	Most facts traceable	Facts not sourced
Explanation	Says why it matters with a reason	Says what happened	Lists facts only

	3	2	1
Sources	Two complete credits	One complete credit	Missing or incomplete
Language	Connected sentences, academic verbs	Simple sentences, clear	Words and phrases

ACTIVIDAD 9 · ACTIVITY 9

Gallery walk · Galería del aula

Read three classmates' profiles. Leave a question or a comment that shows you read it.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Profile 1 · Person featured: _____ Written by: _____

Something I learned · Algo que aprendí:

A question I have · Una pregunta que tengo:

Profile 2 · Person featured: _____ Written by: _____

Something I learned · Algo que aprendí:

A question I have · Una pregunta que tengo:

Profile 3 · Person featured: _____ Written by: _____

Something I learned · Algo que aprendí:

A question I have · Una pregunta que tengo:

Frames: I did not know that _____. · I wonder why _____. · How did _____ ? · This connects to _____ in my community because _____.

Explain one connection between a featured person and an issue in your community · Explica una conexión con tu comunidad:

ACTIVIDAD 10 · ACTIVITY 10

Heritage bingo · Board 1

Listen to the clue. Cover the name. Five in a row wins.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Frida Kahlo	Luis Walter Alvarez	Celia Cruz	Antonia Novello	José Hernández
Franklin Chang-Díaz	Gabriela Mistral	Mario Molina	Diego Rivera	Isabel Allende
Pura Belpré	Lin-Manuel Miranda	LIBRE FREE	Dolores Huerta	Julia Alvarez
Oscar De La Hoya	Carlos Santana	Gloria Estefan	Tito Puente	Sandra Cisneros
Laurie Hernandez	Sylvia Mendez	Selena Quintanilla	Ellen Ochoa	Roberto Clemente

Newcomer: the caller reads the roles in Spanish too. **Challenge:** the winner must say one fact about each covered name to claim the win.

ACTIVIDAD 10 · ACTIVITY 10

Heritage bingo · Board 2

Listen to the clue. Cover the name. Five in a row wins.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Jaime Escalante	José Hernández	Pura Belpré	Lin-Manuel Miranda	Mario Molina
Tito Puente	Dolores Huerta	Celia Cruz	Diego Rivera	Oscar De La Hoya
Roberto Clemente	Isabel Allende	LIBRE FREE	Luis Walter Alvarez	Sylvia Mendez
Laurie Hernandez	Gabriela Mistral	Carlos Santana	César Chávez	Gloria Estefan
Severo Ochoa	Sandra Cisneros	Evelyn Miralles	Ellen Ochoa	Antonia Novello

Newcomer: the caller reads the roles in Spanish too. **Challenge:** the winner must say one fact about each covered name to claim the win.

ACTIVIDAD 10 · ACTIVITY 10

Bingo call list · Lista para el que canta

Teacher only. Read the clue, not the name. Read the roles in Spanish for newcomers.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

#	Clue (read this)	Answer
01	This person is an American engineer of Mexican heritage. (<i>Engineer, Astronaut, Leader</i>)	Ellen Ochoa
02	This person grew up in a Mexican American farmworker family. (<i>Engineer, Astronaut</i>)	José Hernández
03	This person was born in Costa Rica and became an American astronaut. (<i>Physicist, Astronaut</i>)	Franklin Chang-Díaz
04	This person was a Mexican chemist who studied Earth's atmosphere. (<i>Chemist, Environmental Scientist</i>)	Mario Molina
05	This person was an American physicist of Spanish heritage. (<i>Physicist, Inventor</i>)	Luis Walter Alvarez
06	This person was a Mexican American labor leader. (<i>Labor Leader, Civil Rights Advocate</i>)	César Chávez
07	This person is a Mexican American labor leader. (<i>Labor Leader, Community Organizer</i>)	Dolores Huerta
08	This person grew up in New York City in a Puerto Rican family. (<i>Judge, Author</i>)	Sonia Sotomayor
09	This person is an American civil rights advocate of Mexican and Puerto Rican heritage. (<i>Civil Rights Advocate</i>)	Sylvia Mendez
10	This person was a Puerto Rican baseball star who played for the Pittsburgh Pirates. (<i>Baseball Player, Humanitarian</i>)	Roberto Clemente
11	This person was a Mexican painter known for her self-portraits. (<i>Painter, Artist</i>)	Frida Kahlo
12	This person was a Mexican artist famous for large murals. (<i>Painter, Mural Artist</i>)	Diego Rivera
13	This person was a Cuban singer celebrated for her powerful voice and energetic performances. (<i>Singer, Performer</i>)	Celia Cruz
14	This person was a Mexican American singer from Texas. (<i>Singer, Performer</i>)	Selena Quintanilla
15	This person was born in Cuba and grew up in Miami. (<i>Singer, Songwriter</i>)	Gloria Estefan
16	This person was born in Puerto Rico and built a career in theater, film, and television. (<i>Actor, Singer, Dancer</i>)	Rita Moreno

#	Clue (read this)	Answer
17	This person is an American composer and performer of Puerto Rican heritage. <i>(Composer, Writer, Performer)</i>	Lin-Manuel Miranda
18	This person was a Chilean poet and teacher. <i>(Poet, Educator)</i>	Gabriela Mistral
19	This person is a Chilean author whose novels explore family, history, and identity. <i>(Novelist, Storyteller)</i>	Isabel Allende
20	This person is a Dominican American writer. <i>(Author, Poet, Educator)</i>	Julia Alvarez
21	This person was born in Puerto Rico and became a physician. <i>(Physician, Public Health Leader)</i>	Antonia Novello
22	This person was a Bolivian American mathematics teacher. <i>(Mathematics Teacher, Educator)</i>	Jaime Escalante
23	This person is a Mexican American author who grew up in Chicago. <i>(Author, Poet)</i>	Sandra Cisneros
24	This person was born in Mexico and became an influential guitarist. <i>(Guitarist, Songwriter)</i>	Carlos Santana
25	This person is a Mexican American boxer from East Los Angeles. <i>(Boxer, Olympic Champion)</i>	Oscar De La Hoya
26	This person was a Puerto Rican librarian, author, and storyteller. <i>(Librarian, Author, Storyteller)</i>	Pura Belpré
27	This person was a musician born in New York City to Puerto Rican parents. <i>(Musician, Composer, Bandleader)</i>	Tito Puente
28	This person is an American gymnast of Puerto Rican heritage. <i>(Gymnast, Olympic Champion)</i>	Laurie Hernandez
29	This person was a Spanish American biochemist. <i>(Biochemist, Researcher)</i>	Severo Ochoa
30	This person is a Venezuelan American engineer. <i>(Engineer, Technology Innovator)</i>	Evelyn Miralles

Answer key · Clave

Teacher only.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Activity 1

1 Ellen Ochoa · 2 César Chávez · 3 Sonia Sotomayor · 4 Roberto Clemente · 5 Frida Kahlo · 6 Lin-Manuel Miranda · 7 Julia Alvarez · 8 Jaime Escalante · 9 Oscar De La Hoya · 10 Severo Ochoa

Activity 2

Science, Space & Health: 01 Ellen Ochoa, 02 José Hernández, 03 Franklin Chang-Díaz, 04 Mario Molina, 05 Luis Walter Alvarez, 21 Antonia Novello, 29 Severo Ochoa, 30 Evelyn Miralles

Justice & Community: 06 César Chávez, 07 Dolores Huerta, 08 Sonia Sotomayor, 09 Sylvia Mendez

Arts & Music: 11 Frida Kahlo, 12 Diego Rivera, 13 Celia Cruz, 14 Selena Quintanilla, 15 Gloria Estefan, 16 Rita Moreno, 17 Lin-Manuel Miranda, 24 Carlos Santana, 27 Tito Puente

Words & Learning: 18 Gabriela Mistral, 19 Isabel Allende, 20 Julia Alvarez, 22 Jaime Escalante, 23 Sandra Cisneros, 26 Pura Belpré

Sports: 10 Roberto Clemente, 25 Oscar De La Hoya, 28 Laurie Hernandez

Activity 4A

Each Spanish verb matches the English verb on the same row of the reference table above it.

Activity 3, 5, 6, 8, 9

Open responses. Score with the rubric in Activity 8: accuracy, explanation, sources, language — and score the language separately from the content.